2.1 The First Texans

4th Grade Social Studies · Video: Chapter 1: The First Texans (Statewide Outreach Center)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Coming to the Americas

For thousands of years, Native Americans were the only people who lived in Texas.

Scientists believe their journey began long ago in East _____.

They came to the Americas by crossing a _____. Today that place is covered by the water of the Bering Strait.

From there, they moved into Canada, North America, Central America, and South America. Many stayed in Texas.

When Europeans arrived, they first landed on islands in the _____. That area is now called the West Indies.

Christopher Columbus was the first person to call Native Americans "_____," but this was a mistake. They lived in the Americas, not India.

Cultural Regions

Texas Native American regions were named after the _____ of the people who lived there.

The four cultural regions are the Gulf, the _____, the Puebloan, and the Southeastern cultural regions.

In each region, Texas Native Americans learned to _____ to the environment in order to survive.

_____ are the ways people meet their needs and wants.

Texas Native Americans depended on the _____ for food, clothing, tools, and supplies to build homes.

A _____ is the way people make rules and laws and decide who will be the leader.

Sharing Ideas and Leaving Clues

Each tribe spoke its own language, so tribes developed a _____ to trade with one another.

Texas Native Americans did not use a written alphabet. They used pictures instead.

A _____ is a picture painted on a wall, rock, or animal hide.

A petroglyph is a picture _____ into rock or clay.

_____ are objects left behind, such as pottery, tools, and jewelry.

By studying these pictures and artifacts, _____ have learned how Texas Native Americans lived.

Ways They Were Alike

Texas tribes practiced _____. They made circles, stripes, birds, and plants on their bodies.

Healers used natural _____ made from herbs and plants to treat illnesses and heal wounds.

_____ are people who hunt, fish, and gather food such as berries and fruits.

All Texas tribes hunted and gathered food. Some, like the Caddo, were also farmers.

Texas tribes were alike in many ways, but they were also different from one another.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
artifact	an object left behind by people long ago
pictograph	a picture painted on a wall, rock, or animal hide
petroglyph	a picture carved into rock
archaeologist	a scientist who studies artifacts to learn how people lived long ago
political system	the way a group makes rules and chooses leaders

Key Takeaways

- The first Texans came from Asia long ago and spread across the Americas.
- Texas Native Americans lived in four cultural regions and used the land to meet their needs.
- Pictographs, petroglyphs, and artifacts help us learn about their lives.